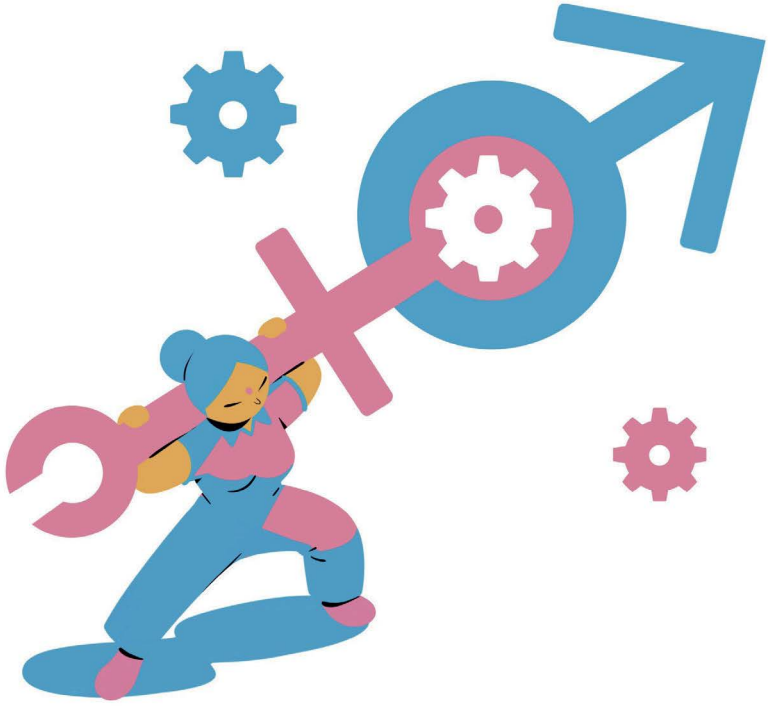
By The Numbers



8.7%
WOMEN'S SHARE OF THE COMBINED AUTOMOTIVE WORKFORCE (OEM/COMPONENT) IN 2025, UP FROM 5.6% IN 2023

11-15%
WOMEN'S SHARE IN ABOUT 11 MILLION EV WORKFORCE, WITH INDUSTRY PROJECTIONS POINTING TOWARDS 50% BY 2030–33

₹70
WHAT WOMEN EARN ROUGHLY FOR EVERY ₹100 MEN EARN IN BLUE-COLLAR AUTOMOTIVE ROLES

14%
OF KEY MANAGEMENT POSITIONS ARE HELD BY WOMEN GLOBALLY; IN AUTO COMPANIES, 18% BOARD POSITIONS ARE HELD BY WOMEN

13%
SHARE OF WOMEN IN WORKFORCE OF MAHINDRA LAST MILE MOBILITY

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for women, they are also taking the helm of India's auto component industry.

For Anjali Singh, executive chairperson of legacy auto-component makers Anand Group and Gabriel and president-designate of the Automotive Component Manufacturers Association of India (ACMA), being a woman leader in the male-dominated industry has hardly been a challenge. "Often, at a conference of 400 men, there are three-four women, but I have never felt any disadvantage. You can have an iron fist with a velvet glove and use it to your advantage. You are on an equal playing field," she tells *BT*.

Singh, who grew up accompanying her father on joint-venture signing trips as a teenager, says many Anand Group plants are headed by women.

However, she believes supportive state policies are equally important. "The number of working hours. The shifts for women. That kind of change is also very structurally important. Automotive has just not been traditionally a field where women went into. So, breaking those barriers down can be tough," she says.

According to Singh, skill development can increase women's participation. "There is a lack of skilled labour in certain belts in the country," she says.

Women have constituted a majority on Gabriel's board for a long time. Besides Singh, it has two external women directors. "That's not because we have to have but we wish to have. We continue to strive to improve those numbers," she adds.

One can assume that these emerging opportunities are only the beginning. As electric mobility reshapes the automotive industry, the change is becoming visible not just in boardrooms but also on the shop floor, where women are taking on roles in battery assembly and manufacturing. Yet, technology alone cannot drive lasting change. Sustaining the momentum will require companies to invest in skills, improve workplace infrastructure and build clearer pathways for women to grow into leadership positions. The real test of this transition will be whether it moves women's participation beyond individual initiatives to become an integral part of the industry's future. BT

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